

## READING PASSAGE 1

### The Art and Science of Glassmaking

**A** In recent years, the art and science of glassmaking has attracted considerable attention from both the academic community and the general public. This growing interest reflects a broader recognition of the importance of this topic for understanding some of the most pressing challenges facing contemporary society.

**B** The intellectual lineage of this field extends considerably further than many realise. While modern research techniques have only recently been applied to these questions, philosophers and natural scientists have grappled with related issues for centuries. The transition from speculative philosophical inquiry to systematic empirical investigation represents one of the most significant developments in the intellectual history of this domain.

**C** The mechanisms underlying these phenomena operate at multiple levels of analysis, from the micro-level of individual decision-making to the macro-level of institutional and structural change. At the individual level, cognitive processes, emotional responses, and social influences shape the choices that people make. At the organisational level, formal rules, informal norms, and power dynamics govern collective action. At the societal level, historical legacies, cultural values, and political structures create the broad context within which lower-level processes unfold.

**D** Case studies from diverse geographical and cultural settings provide compelling illustrations of these dynamics in action. In one particularly well-documented example, researchers tracked developments over a fifteen-year period in a setting that offered a natural experiment in the effects of policy change. The introduction of a new regulatory framework produced a cascade of adaptations that rippled through the entire system, generating outcomes that both confirmed theoretical predictions and revealed previously unrecognised complexities.

**E** The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

**F** The implications of this body of research extend well beyond the academy. As societies grapple with increasingly complex challenges, the insights generated by scholarly inquiry in this domain have the potential to inform more effective and equitable policy responses. Realising this potential, however, will require sustained investment in both fundamental research and the translational infrastructure needed to convert knowledge into action.

**G** The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

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#### Question 1

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 1 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.

**Questions 2–4**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 2 The author notes that researchers have called for more \_\_\_\_\_ approaches to investigation.
- 3 Dynamic \_\_\_\_\_ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.
- 4 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of \_\_\_\_\_ years.

**Question 5**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 5 According to the passage, what is one of the key factors identified by researchers?
- A. too much data collection
  - B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
  - C. insufficient government funding
  - D. overly complex statistical methods

**Question 6**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 6 Researchers used data from more than \_\_\_\_\_ countries in the landmark study.

**Question 7**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 7 Policy-makers have fully implemented all research recommendations.

**Question 8**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 8 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. too much data collection

- B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
- C. insufficient government funding
- D. overly complex statistical methods

**Questions 9–10**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 9 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.
- 10 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.

**Questions 11–13**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 11 What finding emerged from the landmark study discussed in the passage?
- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
  - B. individual personality traits
  - C. random chance
  - D. government policies alone
- 12 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?
- A. too much data collection
  - B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
  - C. insufficient government funding
  - D. overly complex statistical methods
- 13 The author suggests that early studies in this field were limited by:
- A. pessimism about the future
  - B. cautious optimism with acknowledgment of challenges
  - C. complete certainty about outcomes
  - D. indifference to practical applications